

Faizal Malek

Software Developer

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ABOUT

I'm a software developer based in Pretoria with a few years of experience building things for the web — mostly on the front end, though I'm comfortable working across the stack. I got into development through a three-year IT diploma at Rosebank College and have been hands-on ever since, working across contract and full-time roles while picking up new tools as projects demanded them. I enjoy the problem-solving side of development as much as the building side, and I tend to stay curious about how things work under the hood.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Junior Software Developer | [Libex](#) | Feb 2023 – Present

- Build and maintain web apps using React.js and vanilla JavaScript — mostly customer-facing interfaces that needed to be fast and reliable across devices.
- Work in a small cross-functional team using Agile; pick up tickets, join standups, do code reviews. Pretty standard but it keeps things moving.
- Introduced Docker to the workflow to sort out the classic 'works on my machine' problem — made deployments noticeably more consistent across environments.
- Debug and fix front-end issues as they come up, which has taught me more than any greenfield project has.

Front-End Developer (Contract) | [Beyond Horizons Studios](#) | Feb 2023 – Present

- Designed and developed the full BHS website from scratch using WordPress — handled everything from layout and animations to navigation and content structure.
- Worked directly with stakeholders to turn design specs into a working product, making sure the final result matched the brand visually and functionally.
- Kept the site performant and responsive across browsers and screen sizes, which involved a fair amount of testing and fine-tuning.

Live site: beyondhorizonsstudios.com

PHP & Yii Framework Training | [Zilo Group](#) |

- Completed hands-on training in PHP and the Yii framework, building small web apps and getting comfortable with the MVC pattern.
- Focused on writing maintainable code and debugging effectively — habits that have stuck with me since.

PROJECTS

Tourist Guide App

- Built an Android navigation app in Java using Android Studio that lets users explore tourist spots with real-time location data.
- Integrated Google Maps API for routing and Firebase for syncing data live — had to think carefully about latency and offline edge cases.
- Solid exercise in object-oriented design; the project pushed me to structure code properly rather than just making it work.

EDUCATION

- Focused on software development with modules covering databases, mobile development, and cloud platforms.
- Worked with PL/SQL for database projects and Google Cloud/Firebase for cloud-based assignments.
- Built several web and mobile projects during the course — it's where I first got comfortable building full features end to end.

SKILLS & TOOLS

Languages: JavaScript (ES6+), HTML, CSS/SCSS, PHP, Java, SQL

Frameworks & Libraries: React.js, Node.js, Tailwind CSS, Bootstrap, Yii

CMS: WordPress

Databases: MySQL, Firebase Realtime Database

Tools & Workflow: Git, Docker, Agile/Scrum, Android Studio

Cloud: Google Cloud Platform, Firebase

References available on request.